

ALPHA SHIFT

WEBSITE AGENCY BRIEF

Agency Handoff Edition • To be read with the Website Working Book

Shift Thinking. Shape Success.

One brief. Two documents.

This document tells you what we're trying to create and why. The Alpha Shift Website Working Book contains the page copy, programme content, sketchnote directions and other material that brings that thinking to life. Keep both handy. We'll refer to the Working Book as we go.

1. Meet Alpha Shift

Alpha Shift is a coaching, facilitation and consulting practice built around a simple idea: sometimes a useful shift begins not with more information, but with a different way of looking at what is already there.

The brand should feel human, intelligent, visual, thoughtful, premium and approachable.

Please don't make it look like a conventional corporate consulting website. And please don't make it look like children's coaching either. We're looking for the space in between: grown-up, warm, curious and distinctive.

The line is: Shift Thinking. Shape Success.

2. Who we're speaking to

We are not designing for one narrow job title or one industry.

People may arrive because of a tough meeting, an interview, a pitch that matters, a conversation they've been putting off, a decision about what's next, or a business/team that needs something to shift.

Individuals, leaders, teams, organisations, SMEs, solopreneurs and HR/L&D may all find something relevant here.

The language therefore needs to start with recognisable situations and human questions rather than labels, diagnoses or jargon.

3. The website journey

We'd like the site to feel like one unfolding conversation rather than five unrelated pages.

It begins with: "Something on your mind?" It moves through a different way of looking, showing up and staying with it, choosing something relevant to explore, meeting the person behind Alpha Shift, and finally starting a conversation.

The journey should reward someone who follows it, but never require them to. Someone may go Home → Programmes → Let's Explore, arrive directly on a programme, or land straight on Page 5. Every route should still make sense.

The website should give people enough reason to want to reach Let's Explore — without chasing them there.

4. Page-by-page experience

Page 1 — Home: open with a thought, create curiosity, establish the Alpha Shift way of looking, and invite the next step. Sketchnotes carry part of the thinking.

Page 2 — Think · Show Up · Stay: move from curiosity to ownership. We start with the person, not a programme. The tangled-cable visual shows clarity emerging over time.

Page 3 — Programmes: visual discovery through seven sketchnote-led programme cards and crisp overlays. The full approved card/overlay copy is in the Working Book.

Page 4 — Chetan: change gear. Real photography, creative work and artefacts reveal the person behind the thinking. Credentials are present, but quiet.

Page 5 — Let's Explore: make it easy to leave details or book a conversation. This is where the website hands over to the human conversation.

5. Visual language

The site should feel clean, editorial and spacious rather than template-corporate.

Our starting visual language is predominantly black and white with subtle grey, with Alpha Shift orange used sparingly and meaningfully.

Additional colour should earn its place by carrying meaning, not simply because the palette looks sparse.

White space matters. So does restraint. We would rather have one strong visual thought than several decorative elements competing for attention.

The hand-drawn and the polished need to live together.

6. Sketchnotes

The sketchnotes are part of the thinking, not illustrations added afterwards.

They should remain loose, simple and adult. Objects, diagrams, symbols, visual jokes and metaphors are welcome; not every drawing needs a human figure.

Please preserve the character of the hand-drawn work. We do not want it redrawn into polished vector cartoons.

Alpha Shift orange can be used inside a sketchnote when it communicates something — for example, the assisting figure in Owning the Role — rather than simply to brand every drawing.

If a treatment compromises the meaning or legibility of a sketchnote, change the treatment. Protect the idea.

7. Voice, copy and pace

The copy is deliberately conversational. It should sound like a thoughtful person speaking across the table, not a brochure trying to sound clever.

Keep sentences short where they need to breathe. Let questions do some of the work. Don't over-explain an idea that the sketchnote already makes clear.

We want intrigue, not vagueness; confidence, not sales language; warmth, not chumminess.

The Working Book contains the approved copy. Please treat it as the source of truth rather than rewriting it into conventional website language.

On Home in particular, don't read the Working Book line breaks as layout instructions. We imagine typography doing visual work too — changes in scale, weight, italics and emphasis, with some short thoughts flowing together rather than appearing as a long stack of sentences. Compose the words and sketchnotes as one experience, and adapt that treatment intelligently for mobile.

8. What we don't want

No generic corporate stock photography.

No synergy / transformation / disruptive / holistic language.

No over-animation, visual clutter or interactions that exist only to show that they can.

No cartoonish or children's-coaching feel.

No technology stack that creates unnecessary maintenance.

No dependence on the agency for routine content edits.

No clever interaction that someone has to learn before they can use the website.

9. Interaction and movement

Movement should support the thought, not become the thought.

Subtle transitions, reveals or micro-interactions are welcome when they help the visitor understand what changed or where to look next.

Please avoid constant motion, dramatic scroll effects and anything that makes the visitor wait for the website to finish performing.

If you see a subtle way to help people understand where they are, what else they could explore and keep Let's Explore easy to reach, show us — without turning the journey into a progress bar or adding unnecessary screen furniture.

10. The practical experience

We care about the small things that make a site feel considered: clear navigation, sensible tap targets, readable type, accessible contrast, fast loading, predictable behaviour and forms that are easy to complete.

Important content or actions should never depend on hover.

We want the site to feel premium because it is thoughtful and well made — not because it is overloaded with effects.

Where desktop and mobile need different treatments, keep the idea consistent and adapt the execution.

11. The Programme Deck

This is one of the areas we'd particularly like you to help us bring to life.

We have seven programmes. We don't want the Programmes page to feel like seven service descriptions stacked one after another. We'd like it to feel visual, browsable and inviting to explore.

Our preferred direction is sketchnote-led cards. Each programme has its own sketchnote; the drawing makes the central thought visible. Rather than placing a small drawing alongside a block of copy, we'd like to explore making the sketchnote the visual face of the programme card itself.

A card contains: programme name, one-line promise, sketchnote as the dominant visual, and "Take a closer look →". That's deliberately not much.

"Take a closer look →" opens a deliberately crisp overlay: one recognition line, a little more about what we might work on, a Try This prompt, Choose the depth: 60 mins — Open it up · 180 mins — Work it through · 360 mins — Make it usable, and "Let's explore →". The complete approved copy is in the Working Book.

Two invitations, two jobs: "Take a closer look" means I'm curious about this programme. "Let's explore" means I'd like to take this further. Please don't use them interchangeably.

The sketchnote doesn't need an encore. It lives on the card; the overlay continues the thought.

We've been calling this the Programme Deck, but that describes the idea more than the interface. Deck, carousel, stack, spread, swipe or something else — show us what works on desktop and mobile.

One important caveat: we like the card idea. We like the sketchnotes more. Test all seven. If the format compromises a drawing, don't force it. A looser tile/visual-section treatment is preferable while keeping browse → choose → crisp overlay → Let's explore.

Give us a family, not seven clones.

12. Founder Treatment

By the time someone reaches this page, they've already met Alpha Shift. Now they meet Chetan.

We don't want the inevitable founder photograph → impressive biography → qualifications → career history → contact button. There's a CV for that.

Let the page change gear. The first three pages lean on words and sketchnotes; here we want real photographs, personal work, artefacts and moments. It should feel more editorial and personal without becoming another website.

There's more than a career here. Experience across banking, fintech, marketing, education and business matters, but so do curiosity, learning, introspection, experimentation and asking questions.

You'll have portraits/candid, photography across genres including internationally awarded work, the New Delhi street-food coffee-table book, a stand-up performance image and possibly other unexpected material.

Please resist the trophy cabinet. These are clues to the person, not an achievements gallery.

One thought to explore: photographs displayed with a subtle reference to prints once hung to dry after processing — clipped to a line and discovered as you move along it. It's an idea, not an instruction. If it starts looking like laundry, save us from ourselves.

Credentials belong in a quiet “A little of the formal stuff” strip. Reassurance, not introduction. No wall of certificates or alphabet soup after the name.

We'd rather someone leave thinking “I have a sense of the person I'd be talking to” than merely “He has an impressive background”.

13. Contact / Let's Explore

If someone wants to talk to us, we shouldn't make it difficult. This page just needs to help them start the conversation.

It must work equally well for someone who has explored every page and someone who came straight here. Give enough context to start, without another explanation of Alpha Shift.

Don't make people diagnose themselves. They do not need to choose one of seven programmes before speaking to us.

Give them two easy ways in: tell us briefly what's on their mind, or book a conversation through Topmate. Email and LinkedIn should remain easy to find.

Keep the form short. Acknowledge successful submission/booking in a simple human way.

We want the website to lead people here naturally, not push them here. The website gets them to the conversation. From there, we take over.

14. Mobile / Responsive Experience

Let's assume something from the start: a lot of people will meet Alpha Shift on their phone. For many people, mobile isn't the smaller version of the website. It is the website.

Please design for that from the beginning rather than designing desktop first and squeezing everything down later.

The words need room. Sketchnotes need to remain understandable. Programme Cards need to be enjoyable to browse. Overlays need to feel crisp. Founder photography still needs presence. Let's Explore must remain easy to reach.

Don't be afraid to treat mobile differently. Keep the idea consistent; the treatment can change.

Test every sketchnote on the small screen. Protect the idea, not necessarily every pixel.

No hover dependency. Be careful with sticky menus, floating buttons, chat widgets and other screen furniture. Fingers are less precise than cursors.

Please test the real journey on actual devices: Home → Programmes → card → overlay → Let's Explore → contact/book.

We never want someone to think: “I should probably open this properly on my laptop later.”

15. CMS / Editability

We should be able to change everyday content ourselves. Changing a photograph, correcting a sentence or updating a programme shouldn't require a call to the agency.

That includes copy, programme/card/overlay content, sketchnote images, photographs, credentials, links/contact information and booking information.

Easy means actually easy. The editing experience should be clear enough that someone familiar with everyday digital tools can make routine changes without worrying about breaking the page.

Please don't over-engineer it. We care about ease of use, reliability, security, performance, reasonable ongoing costs and not discovering that a simple site needs twelve plugins and four subscriptions.

Before handover, show us how to make the everyday changes and leave a simple reference afterwards.

We know the difference between an edit and something new. If later we want a new page, new content type or new functionality, we understand that may mean coming back to you. If we want to change the website, we may need you. If we want to change what the website says, we usually shouldn't.

16. Assets / Handover

When the website is ready, we'd like the handover to be just that — a handover.

We shouldn't discover later that something important still lives only in an agency account, on somebody's laptop or behind a login we don't have.

Where practical, important accounts should be created in or transferred to Alpha Shift's control: domain, hosting and other essential services. If something remains agency-managed, tell us upfront what that means.

At handover, provide appropriate admin access, final agreed design/site assets, website-specific graphics, relevant licence/usage information, third-party integration details, analytics access and anything else reasonably needed to operate the site.

Please be clear about what we own and what is licensed, including ongoing costs.

Leave us a useful handover reference: where things live, how to access them, what we can safely update, what we shouldn't touch and what needs renewing.

Before we say we're done, check access, accounts, integrations, forms, booking routes, analytics, mobile experience and everyday editing in the live environment.

Then we can shake hands. And Alpha Shift leaves with the keys. You're always welcome to knock.

17. Surprise Us

We've given you quite a lot to work with. But this is still a brief, not a design.

We don't want you simply to execute our ideas. If you see a better way to present something, tell us. If something we've suggested doesn't work, tell us. If you find an interaction, layout, transition or visual idea that feels unmistakably right for Alpha Shift and we haven't thought of it: surprise us. But surprise isn't spectacle. We'd rather someone think "That makes sense" and then, perhaps a moment later, "That was rather nice."

Play within the character: human, intelligent, visual, thoughtful, premium, approachable, and a little playful when the moment allows it.

Look for the little opportunities too — how a sketchnote appears, how a card responds, how photography is discovered, how a tiny interaction makes someone smile, how Let's Explore appears at the right moment.

Challenge us if something compromises usability, accessibility, performance or the overall experience. Understand why we imagined it before proposing something better.

Make it feel like Alpha Shift.

We've shared our thinking, our ideas and what matters to us.

Now we'd love to see what you do with it.

And if along the way you make us shift our thinking too, even better.